FIRST CORINTHIANS

Conversational Version

Salutation

1:1 Paul, apostle of Christ[Messiah] Jesus by God's will, and Sosthenes our brother, **2**to God's church in Corinth, made holy in Christ and called *to be* saints with everyone everywhere that calls on our Lord. **3**Grace and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ. **1 Cor 1:1-3**

Thanksgiving

4I always thank God for you *and* for the grace he's given you in Jesus. **5**He has enriched you in word and knowledge, **6**and confirmed in you the testimony about Christ. **7**So you don't lack any gift as you anxiously wait for our Lord's return. **8**He'll continue to confirm you to the end so you'll be blameless then. **9**You can rely on God, who called you into fellowship with his Son. **1 Cor 1:4-9**

Call for Unity

10I urge you, by our Lord Jesus Christ, to live in harmony so there's no division among you. Unite in mind and purpose. **11**Chloe's family has told me about the rivalry that's going on among you. **12**This is what I mean: each of you is saying, *"I'm with Paul"; "I'm with Apollos"*; *"I'm with Cephas"*; *"I'm with Christ."* **13**Is Christ divided up? Paul wasn't crucified for you, was he? Were you baptized to Paul? **14**I'm glad I didn't baptize any of you except Crispus and Gaius, **15**so you couldn't say I baptized you to myself. (**16**I did baptize the family of Stephanas; I don't remember baptizing anyone else.) **17**Christ didn't send me to perform baptisms, but to deliver good news, not with an eloquence that could detract from the power of his cross. **1 Cor 1:10-17**

Christ as Our Wisdom

18The preaching about the cross is foolishness to people that perish; it's God's power to the people that are saved. **19**Scripture says,

> ***"I'll destroy the wisdom of the wise***
> ***and set aside the insight of the insightful"*** **[Is 29:14]**.

20Where's the "wise"? Where's the scribe? Where's the skillful reasoner of this world? Hasn't God made foolish the world's "wisdom"? **21**In his wisdom, the world didn't know him by wisdom. It pleased him to save believers by the "foolishness" of what we preach. **22**Jews ask for signs; Greeks look for wisdom; **23**but we preach Christ crucified, a stumbling block to Jews and foolishness to Greeks. **24**But, to those who are called—Jews or Greeks—Christ is God's power and wisdom. **25**God's foolishness is wiser than men; his weakness is stronger than men. **1 Cor 1:18-25**

[26]You don't see many wise, powerful, noble people called. [27]God has chosen what's foolish to the world to put the wise to shame, weak things to put strong things to shame, [28]insignificant and disregarded things—even what's not—to cancel out what is. [29]He did it so nobody could act "proud" in his presence. [30]By him you're in Christ Jesus, who has become for us a wisdom, goodness, sanctification, and redemption that comes from God. [31]Like scripture says, ***"Whoever is proud should be proud of what he has in the LORD"*** **[Jer 9:24].** **1 Cor 1:26-31**

The Message, not the Medium

2:[1]When I came, I didn't use eloquence or wisdom to present what God had not previously revealed. [2]I determined not to know anything among you but Jesus Christ crucified. [3]I was weak and apprehensive while I was with you. [4]I didn't present my message with eloquent words but with powerful demonstration of the Spirit. [5]I did that so your faith wouldn't rest on human wisdom but on divine power.

[6]We do speak a kind of wisdom among mature people, but it's not the kind the world or its rulers offer—who are passing away. [7]It's a previously unrevealed wisdom from God, *a wisdom* predestined before creation to our honor, [8]*a wisdom* that no rulers in the world knew. If they'd known it, they wouldn't have crucified the glorious Lord. [9]Like scripture says,

> ***"Eye hasn't seen, ear hasn't heard,***
> *it hasn't entered people's mind*
> *what God's prepared for those who love him"* **[Is 64:4; 52:15;** Sir 1:10**].**

1 Cor 2:1-9

Revelation, Not Philosophy

[10]But God has revealed *them* to us by the Spirit, who examines everything, including the deep things about God. [11]Who knows a person's things except that person's spirit? The same way with God: nobody knows his things except his Spirit. [12]We didn't receive the spirit of the world, but the Spirit from God so we could know what God's graciously given us. [13]We talk about those things, not in terms that human wisdom teaches, but in *terms* the Spirit teaches, explaining spiritual matters in spiritual terms. [14]Material-minded people don't welcome God's spiritual things; they seem like foolishness to them. *Material-minded* people can't figure out spiritual things because spiritual things are examined from a spiritual point of view. [15]Spiritual people have a point of view for examining everything, but nobody can examine them.

> [16]***"Who knows the mind of the LORD;***
> ***Who's going to advise him?"*** **[Is 40:13].**

But we have the mind of Christ. **1 Cor 2:10-16**

Christ, Not His Messengers

3:[1]Members of Christ's family, I couldn't talk to you like spiritual people, but like material-minded ones, like infants in Christ. [2]I gave you milk, not solid food. You couldn't *eat*

solid food and still can't. [3]You're still material minded. While jealousy and conflict *exist* among you, aren't you material minded and act like typical people? [4]When any of you says, *"I'm with Paul," "I'm with Apollos,"* aren't you material minded and act like typical people? [5]What's Apollos? What's Paul? Ministers that led you to faith. [6]I planted, Apollos watered, but God made it grow. [7]So the one that plants or waters isn't important, but God who makes it grow. [8]The one that plants and the one that waters combine their efforts, and God will pay each one for his own work. [9]We're God's fellow workers; you're his field, his building. **1 Cor 3:1-9**

Christians as God's Temple

[10]By God's grace, like a skilled general contractor, I've laid a foundation, and others are building on it. They need to be careful how they do that. [11]Nobody can lay any other foundation than the One I've laid, which is Jesus Christ. [12]If you[sg] build on it with gold, silver, precious stones—wood, hay, straw, [13]time will tell how good your work proves to be; fire will test it and make that obvious. [14]If your[sg] work lasts, you'll get paid. [15]If it burns up, you'll take a loss, but you'll be saved—but as through fire. [16]Don't you[pl] know you're[pl] God's temple, and God's Spirit lives in you[pl]? [17]If you[sg] destroy his temple, he'll destroy you[sg]. His temple is holy; that's what you[pl] are.

[18]Don't kid yourselves. If any of you think you're wise in the world, you need to become "foolish" to become wise. [19]The world's wisdom amounts to foolishness as far as God's concerned. Scripture says,

> ***"He traps the crafty in their craftiness"*** **[Job 5:13];**

[20]and,

> ***"The LORD knows that the speculations of the wise are meaningless"*** **[Ps 94:11]**.

[21]So, don't anyone take pride in other people. Everything belongs to you: [22]Paul, Apollos, Cephas; the world, life, death; things present, things to come. *They're* all yours, [23]you're Christ's, and Christ is God's. **1 Cor 3:10-23**

Attitude Toward Christ's Ministers

4:1 People should consider us ministers of Christ and stewards of God's mysteries. [2]A steward must be reliable, [3]but it's not important to me that you or any human court would try to evaluate me; I don't even try to evaluate myself. [4]My conscience is clear, but that doesn't make me right. The Lord's the One that evaluates me. [5]So, don't rush to judgment before the Lord comes. He'll bring to light what darkness hides and reveal the motives in *people's* hearts. Then God will do the complimenting. **1 Cor 4:1-5**

[6]I've applied these matters to me and Apollos to teach you not to go beyond what scripture says, so none of you will get conceited. [7]Who makes you[sg] superior? What do you[sg] have you didn't receive? If you received it, why act proud as if you didn't. [8]You're[pl] full! You're

rich! You've become kings without us! I wish you had become kings so we could reign with you. **9**I think God has placed us apostles last as sentenced to death. We've become a spectacle to the world, to angels, and to people. **10**We're fools for Christ; you're wise in him! We're weak; you're strong! We're disrespected; you're respectable! **11**To this day we're hungry, thirsty, poorly clothed, harassed, homeless, **12-13**and do manual labor. We bless in return for insult and encourage in return for slander. We're patient when persecuted, and still treated like trash—like the scum of the earth. **1 Cor 4:6-13**

14I'm not writing this to make you feel bad, but to warn you like children I care about. **15**You may have countless instructors in Christ, but not lots of fathers. I became your father in Christ through the good news. **16**So follow my example. **17**That's why I'm sending Timothy, my dear friend, reliable child in the Lord. He'll remind you about my ways in the Lord like I teach everywhere in every church. **18**Some of you proudly claim that I won't come to you. **19**But I'll come soon, Lord willing, and I'll find out, not the talk of the proud, but their power. **20**God's kingdom is not in talk but in power. **21**What do you want me to do, come with a rod or with love and a gentle spirit? **1 Cor 4:14-21**

Immorality in Corinth

5:1 Immorality is reported among you that doesn't exist even among Gentiles—someone living with his father's wife. **2**Are you proud *of this* instead of mourning *over it*—a mourning that should lead to removing him from you? **3**I'm absent in body but present in spirit, and already—as if present—I've judged him. **4**In the name of our Lord Jesus, assemble with my spirit and the power of our Lord Jesus Christ, **5**and deliver him to Satan to destroy the flesh but save his spirit when the Lord comes. **6**Your pride is not good. Don't you understand that a little yeast spreads through the whole batch? **7**Get rid of the old yeast so you're a fresh batch. You're a fresh *batch* because Christ our Passover has been sacrificed. **8**So let's celebrate the feast, not with old, evil yeast, but with unleavened bread of sincerity and truth.

9I've written to you not to associate with immoral people. **10***I* don't *mean* immoral people in the world—covetous people, swindlers, idolaters. You'd have to get out of the world *to do that!* **11**Now I'm writing to you not to associate with anyone called a Christian that's immoral or covetous, an idolater, slanderer, or drunk—not to eat with someone like that. **12**What business is it of mine to judge people outside *the church*? Isn't it your responsibility to judge the ones in *the church*? **13**God will judge the rest. ***"Remove the sinful person from you"*** **[Deut 17:7; 19:19; 22:21, 24; 24:7].** **1 Cor 5:1-13**

Christians and Lawsuits

6:1 If you have something against a *fellow Christian*, do any of you dare go to court in front of sinners rather than saints? **2**You know, don't you, that the saints will judge the world? If

you're going to judge the world, can't you *judge* small matters? [3]You know, don't you, that you'll judge angels, much less matters of everyday life? [4]If you have courts that deal with everyday matters, appoint *as judges* the ones looked down on in the church. [5]I'm saying this so you'll be ashamed: don't you have anybody among you smart enough to decide between his fellow believers? [6]Christians take Christians to court and do it in front of unbelievers? [7]It's a real defect in you that you bring lawsuits against each other. Wouldn't it be better to let yourselves be wronged or defrauded? [8]But <u>you</u> do the wronging and defrauding, and *do it* to fellow Christians, at that. [9]Don't you know that bad people won't inherit God's kingdom? Don't kid yourselves: sexually immoral people, idolaters, adulterers, effeminate *men*, homosexuals, [10]thieves, covetous people, drunkards, revilers, swindlers won't inherit his kingdom. [11]Some of you were like that, but you were washed, sanctified, made good in the Lord Jesus and in the Spirit of our God.

1 Cor 6:1-11

[12]I can do all *kinds of* things, but they're not all beneficial, and I won't put myself under their control. [13]Food's for the stomach, and the stomach's for food, but God will destroy it and them. The body is not for immorality, but for the Lord; and the Lord is for the body. [14]But God has resurrected the Lord, and he'll resurrect us by his power. [15]Don't you know your bodies are parts of Christ? So am I going to take parts of Christ and make *them* parts of a prostitute? Goodness, no! [16]Don't you know that whoever joins himself to a prostitute is one body *with her* physically? *God* says, ***"The two will become one physical identity"*** **[Gen 2:24]**. [17]Whoever joins himself to the Lord is one spiritual identity *with him*. [18]Run from sexual immorality. Every sin a person commits is aside from the body, but sexual sin is a sin against a person's own body. [19]Don't you know your[pl] body is a temple for God's Holy Spirit that's in you[pl]? You[pl] don't own yourselves; [20]you've been purchased. So praise God with your body. **1 Cor 6:12-20**

Teaching About Marriage

7:[1]Regarding the things you wrote about. It's okay for a man to stay single. [2]But, to avoid sexual immorality, each man should have his own wife, and each woman should have her own husband. [3]A husband needs to give his wife what's due her, and vice versa. [4]A wife doesn't have *sole* rights over her own body; her husband *does too*. The same for a husband. [5]Don't refuse sex to one another except for a while by agreement to devote yourselves to prayer. Then come together again so Satan doesn't tempt you because of your lack of self-control. [6]I say that as a concession, not a commandment. [7]I'd like everyone to be like me, but each person has his gift from God—one, one way; another, another way. **1 Cor 7:1-7**

[8]I say to unmarried people and widows, it's good to stay like me. [9]But if you don't have self-control, get married; it's better to marry than to lust. [10]But the Lord, not *just* me, instructs a wife not to divorce her husband—[11]if she does divorce him, she needs to stay single or be

reconciled to him—and a husband not to leave his wife. [12]To the rest I say, not the Lord, if a disciple has an unbelieving wife and she's willing to keep living with him, he shouldn't leave her. [13]If a wife has an unbelieving husband and he's perfectly content to keep living with her, she shouldn't leave him. [14]A *believing* wife legitimizes an unbelieving husband and vice versa; otherwise, your children would be illegitimate. [15]If an unbelieving *spouse* does divorce, let *him or her* divorce. A brother or sister isn't bound in such cases. God has called us in peace. [16]How do you know, wife, that perhaps you'll save *your* husband; or husband, that you'll save *your* wife? **1 Cor 7:8-16**

[17]Keep living in the *societal* circumstance where God called you. That's what I tell everybody in all the churches. [18]Were you called as circumcised? You don't need to get uncircumcised. Were you called as uncircumcised? You don't need to get circumcised. [19]Circumcision or uncircumcision doesn't matter. Keeping God's commandments is what matters.

[20]Keep living in the circumstance where God called you. [21]Were you called as a slave? It doesn't matter. (But, if you <u>can</u> be free, do it.) [22]A person the Lord calls that's a servant is free as far as he is concerned. A person the Lord calls tthat's a freeman is the Lord's 'servant.' [23]You've been purchased for a price; don't become servants to other people. [24]Stay with God in the circumstance where he called you. **1 Cor 7:17-24**

Advice to the Unmarried

[25]About virgins. I don't have any command from the Lord, but I offer *my* opinion as somebody he has been merciful enough to consider dependable. [26]I recommend handling the matter this way in light of present difficulties: it's good for you to stay the way you are. [27]Are you married? Don't get a divorce. Are you single? Don't look for somebody to marry. [28]If you do get married, you haven't sinned; if a virgin gets married, she hasn't sinned. But *married* people will face difficulties in this life, and I want to spare you. [29]I'm telling you, it won't be long till the ones that have wives will be as if they didn't, [30]those crying or rejoicing as if they weren't, [31]and those taking advantage of this world's opportunities as not doing it fully. The situation's changing, [32]and I don't want you to have *distracting* concerns. An unmarried man tends to concern himself with the Lord's things—how to please him; [33]a married man feels a need to concern himself with this world's things—how to be pleasing to his wife [34]and is torn. Unmarried women and virgins tend to be concerned about the Lord's things—being holy in body and spirit; a married woman feels a need to concern herself with this world's things—how to be pleasing to her husband. [35]I'm saying this to help you, not to hold you back—to free you for orderly, undistracted devotion to the Lord. **1 Cor 7:25-35**

36If a man thinks he's being insensitive toward his virgin *daughter*, if she's full-grown and wants to get married, he should follow his heart. He's not sinning; do what he's inclined to do; let them marry. **37**But a man that's made up his mind, stands firm in his heart, is under no pressure, has decided as far as he's concerned to keep his virgin, he's doing a good thing. **38**So, the one who gives his virgin *daughter* in marriage does well, and the one that doesn't does better.

39A wife is married to her husband for as long as he's alive. If he dies, she's free to marry whoever she wants to—only in the Lord. **40**But she'd be happier if she stayed like she is, but that's just me. I think I also have God's Spirit. **1 Cor 7:36-40**

Meat Offered to Idols

8:1 About things offered to idols. We all have knowledge. Knowledge tends to make a person proud; love builds other people up. **2**If anybody thinks he knows, he doesn't know like he should. **3**If anybody loves God, God knows it. **4**So, as to eating things offered to idols, we know idols aren't real and there's no God but one. **5**There are lots of so-called gods and lords in the sky and on earth. **6**But for us

there's one God, the Father—
from whom everything *has come* and
for whom we *live*—and
there's one Lord, Jesus Christ—
by whom everything *has come*
and by whom we *live*. **1 Cor 8:1-6**

7But not everybody knows that. Some people were used to idols before. *They were used* to eating food as an offering to them. Eating that kind of food grates on their conscience now. Their conscience is weak, and it bothers them. **8**Food doesn't make us acceptable to God: if we don't eat, we're not worse; if we do, we're not better. **9**But be careful that your[pl] freedom doesn't make weak people stumble. **10**If someone sees you[pl] that have knowledge reclining at table in an idol's temple, won't their weak conscience be inclined to eat to *the idol* the things offered to the idol? **11**Your[pl] knowledge is destroying a weak Christian Christ died for. **12**When you sin that way against members of Christ's body and grate on their tender conscience, you're[pl] sinning against Christ. **13**So if what I eat makes my fellow Christians stumble, I'll never eat meat because I don't want to make them stumble. **1 Cor 8:7-13**

Paul's Defense of His Apostleship

9:1 Am I not free? Am I not an apostle? Haven't I seen Jesus our Lord? Aren't you my work in the Lord? **2**If I'm not an apostle to other people, I am to you. You're the seal of my apostleship in the Lord.

[3]Here's my defense to the ones who are criticizing me. [4]Don't I have a right to eat? [5]Don't I have a right to have a wife *that's* a sister *in the faith* like Cephas, the rest of the apostles, and the Lord's brothers? [6]Are Barnabas and I the only ones that don't have a right not to work? [7]What soldier ever serves at his own expense? Who plants a vineyard and doesn't eat its fruit? Who tends sheep and doesn't drink their milk? [8]I'm not just talking about human custom, am I? Doesn't the Law *of Moses* say that too? [9]***"Don't put a muzzle on an ox while it's threshing"*** **[Deut 25:4].** God's not concerned *here* about oxen, is he? [10]Isn't he speaking for <u>our</u> benefit? He wrote it for our benefit so the one who's threshing should work in hopes of sharing in the crops. [11]If we sowed spiritual things to you, *is it* too much to reap material things from you? [12]If other people share that right, don't we e*ven* more? **1 Cor 9:1-12a**

But we haven't used that right. We endure things to keep from hindering the good news of Christ in any way. [13]Don't you know that the ones who perform sacred services eat from the Temple, *and that* the ones who wait on the altar have a share from the altar? [14]In the same way the Lord has directed that the ones who deliver the good news should have a living from it. [15]But I haven't taken advantage of that provision, and I'm not writing this to change what we've been doing. I'd rather die than let anyone make my pride hollow. [16]If I deliver the good news, I don't have anything to take pride in. I <u>have</u> to do that. Woe to me if I don't! [17]If I do it because I want to, I'm entrusted with a stewardship. [18]Where's my reward then? That I deliver the good news for free and not make use of my rights in it. **1 Cor 9:12b-18**

[19]Although I'm free from everybody, I've made myself a servant to everybody so I can win more of them. [20]To Jews I've become like a Jew to win Jews. To people under law I've become like somebody under law—though I'm not *really*—to win people under law. [21]To people not under law I've become like somebody not under law—though I am under God's law, Christ's 'law'—to win people not under law. [22]To the weak I've become weak to win the weak. By all means I've become all things to all *people* to save some. [23]I do everything for the sake of the good news so I can partake of it.

[24]As you know, everybody in a race runs, but only one wins the garland. Run so you'll be the one that wins it. [25]Everybody that competes in the games exercises self-discipline in everything. <u>They</u> do it for a crown that deteriorates; <u>we</u> *do it* for one that doesn't. [26]I don't *just* run around; I don't just shadow box. I discipline my body and keep it under control so, after I preach to other people, <u>I</u> don't disqualify myself. **1 Cor 9:19-26**

Boundaries of Christian Liberty

10[:1]I want you to know that our forefathers passed through the sea under the cloud. [2]They were baptized to Moses in the cloud and sea. [3]They ate the same spiritual food [4]and drank the same spiritual drink: they drank from the spiritual rock that followed them—the Christ[Messiah].

[5]But God wasn't pleased with most of them and struck them down in the wilderness. [6]What happened with them serves as an example for us not to crave evil things like they did, [7]or worship idols like some of them did, ***"The people sat down to gluttony and got up to revelry"*** **[Ex 32:6]**. [8]*We must not* commit sexual sin like some of them did, and 23,000 fell in one day. [9]Let's not put Christ to trial like some of them did, and snakes killed them; [10]or complain like some of them did, and the destroyer destroyed them. [11]Scripture recorded those events to warn us later [12]so whoever thinks he's standing would be careful not to fall. [13]You haven't faced anything beyond normal human experience. God's reliable; he won't let you face more than you can handle. He'll provide an escape so you can handle it. **1 Cor 10:1-13**

[14]So run away from idolatry. [15]I'm talking to you as intelligent people; pay attention to what I'm saying. [16]Isn't the cup of blessing that we bless, a sharing in Christ's blood? Isn't the loaf we break a participation in his body? [17]Since there's one loaf, the many of us are one body and share the one loaf. [18]Look at physical Israel. Don't the ones that eat the sacrifices share in the altar? [19]So am I saying that something offered to an idol has value or that an idol has any value? [20]*No*, *I'm saying* that what people sacrifice, *they sacrifice* to demons, not God. And I don't want you involved with demons. [21]You can't drink the cup of the Lord and the cup of demons. You can't participate in the table of the Lord and the table of demons. [22]Are we trying to make the Lord jealous? We aren't stronger than he is, are we? **1 Cor 10:14-22**

[23]Not everything that's possible is beneficial. [24]Don't look after your own welfare as much as others' welfare. [25]Eat whatever they sell in the marketplace; don't ask any questions for conscience sake, [26]because, ***"The earth and everything in it belong to the LORD"*** **[Ps 24:1; 50:12; 89:11, 27]**. [27]If an unbeliever invites you *to dinner* and you want to go, eat anything he sets in front of you without asking any questions for conscience sake. [28]But if somebody says, *"This is offered in sacrifice,"* don't eat it [29]out of consideration for the other person's conscience. Why does someone else's conscience limit my freedom? [30]If I eat with thanks, why am I slandered for it? [31]Whether you eat or drink or whatever you do, do it to God's honor. [32]Don't do anything that hurts Jews or Gentiles or God's church. [33]I aim to be pleasing to everybody in everything I do. I don't try to do what's best for me, but for everybody's benefit so I can save them. **11**:[1]Follow my example like I follow Christ's. **1 Cor 10:23-11:1**

Women's Decorum in Worship

[2]I commend you for remembering me and maintaining the customs I passed on to you. [3]I want you to know that God is the head of Christ, Christ is the head of every husband, and a husband *is head* of a wife. [4]A man that prays or prophesies with his head covered disgraces his head. [5]A woman that prays or prophesies bareheaded disgraces her head. It's the same as shaving

it. [6]If a woman is bareheaded, she may as well be bald. If it's shameful for a woman to cut her hair off, she should cover her head. [7]A man shouldn't cover his head because he's the image and delight of God. A wife is her husband's delight. [8]Man didn't come from woman, but woman from man. [9]Man wasn't created for woman, but woman for man. [10]So she should wear *a sign of* authority on her head because of the angels. [11]But, in the Lord a husband and wife exist as a combination. [12]As woman *came* from man, man *comes* by woman, and everything *comes* from God. [13]Judge for yourselves: is it appropriate for a woman to pray to God bareheaded? [14]Doesn't what's natural teach you that long hair dishonors a man, [15]but it honors a woman? Long hair serves as a covering for her. [16]If someone wants to argue about it, we don't have such a custom; neither do the churches of God. **1 Cor 11:2-16**

The Lord's Supper

[17]In this *next* instruction, I'm not commending you, because your getting together doesn't make things better but worse. [18]To begin with, when you get together for church, I hear there are divisions among you, and I'm inclined to believe it. [19]Divisions even need to exist to show who are approved. [20]When you get together, you can't be eating the Lord's Supper. [21]Each one is bringing out his own supper, and one's hungry while another overeats. [22]Don't you have houses to eat in? Do you disrespect God's church and embarrass people that don't have *anything to eat*? What can I say to you? Can I compliment you? Not for that, I can't. **1 Cor 11:17-22**

[23]I received from the Lord what I passed on to *you*. The night he was betrayed, he took a loaf, [24]gave thanks, broke it, and said, *"This is my body, which is for you. Do this in memory of me."* [25]After the meal *he took* the cup, *"This cup is the New Covenant in my blood. As often as you drink it, do it in memory of me."* [26]As often as you eat this bread and drink the cup, you're expressing the Lord's death till he comes.

[27]So whoever eats this bread or drinks the cup of the Lord in a way that's not appropriate, is guilty of his body and blood. [28]That's why you need to examine yourself and eat the bread and drink the cup that way. [29]If you eat and drink without recognizing the [Lord's][ms] body, you eat and drink condemnation to yourself. [30]That's why many of you are weak and sickly, and a considerable *number* are dying. [31]If we examine ourselves, we won't be condemned. [32]When we judge ourselves, the Lord disciplines us so we won't be condemned along with the world. [33]So when you get together to eat, be considerate. [34]If you're hungry, eat at home to avoid being condemned. I'll straighten out the rest when I get there. **1 Cor 11:23-34**

Teaching on Spiritual Gifts

12:[1]About spiritual *gifts*. [2]You know that when you were pagans, in one way or another, idols that couldn't talk were leading you astray. [3]So I tell you, nobody that speaks by God's

Spirit claims, *"Jesus is accursed"*; and nobody can claim, *"Jesus is Lord,"* except by the Holy Spirit.

4There's a variety of spiritual gifts, but the same Spirit; **5**a variety of ministries, but the same Lord; **6**a variety of activities, but the same God, who accomplishes everything in everyone. **7**The demonstration each person has from the Spirit serves for the benefit of the rest. **8**The same Spirit gives a message about wise living to one and a message about understanding to another, **9**faith to one and gifts of healing to another; **10**working miracles to one, prophesying to another, and distinguishing between spirits to another; *speaking* different languages to one and translating languages to another. **11**The same Spirit does them all and distributes to each person as he sees fit. **1 Cor 12:1-11**

The Church as a Body

12As one body has many parts, so does Christ. **13**We were baptized in one Spirit into one body—whether Jew or Greek, bond or free—and drank from one Spirit. **14**The body doesn't have one part, but many. **15**If a foot says, *"Since I'm not a hand, I'm not part of the body,"* is it then not part of the body? **16**If an ear says, *"Since I'm not an eye, I'm not part of the body,"* is it then not part of the body? **17**If the whole body *were an* eye, how would it hear anything? If the whole body *were* hearing, where *would* it smell anything? **18**God has placed each part in the body just the way he wants it. **19**If they were all one part, where *would* the *whole* body *be*? **20**There are many parts, but one body. **21**An eye can't tell a hand, *"I don't need you."* The head can't tell the feet, *"I don't need you."* **22**More notably yet, parts we consider weaker are necessary. **23**Parts we consider less honorable we give more attention to; our less presentable parts become more presentable, **24**and parts that are already presentable get less attention. God has put the body together in a way that gives greater honor to the part that lacks *it*, **25**so there's no division in the body because the parts take care of each another. **26**If one part suffers, they all suffer; if one receives honor, they all rejoice. **1 Cor 12:12-26**

27*As a group* you're Christ's body, and individually *you're* parts *of it*. **28**In the church, God has appointed apostles first, prophets second, teachers third, then miracles, gifts of healing, helps, administrations, kinds of languages. **29**Not everyone is an apostle or prophet or teacher or miracle worker, are they? **30**Not everyone has gifts for healing or speaks in languages or translates, do they? **1 Cor 12:27-30**

Love , the All-Purpose Virtue

31Earnestly desire the more important gifts, but I'll show you something *even* better. **13:1**If I speak in the languages of people and angels, but don't love, like a noisy gong or crashing cymbal <u>I *mean anything*</u>. **2**If I prophesy, understand all mysteries, know everything, have enough faith to move mountains, but don't love, <u>I am nothing</u>. **3**If I give everything I own

to feed *the poor* and give up my body so I can take pride *in doing it*, but don't love, I gain nothing.

[4]Love is patient and kind, not jealous or proud. [5]It's considerate, not selfish or easily offended; it doesn't dwell on what's wrong. [6]Love doesn't enjoy doing people in; it enjoys the truth. [7]Love bears up under everything; it tends to trust; it hopes for the best. Love lasts.

[8]Love never falls *out of the picture*. But prophesying will pass away; languages will stop; knowledge will disappear. [9]We know partially and prophecy partially. [10]But, when what's final comes, what's preliminary will disappear. [11]When I was a kid, I talked like one, thought like one, reasoned like one. When I grew up, I quit doing what a kid does. [12]We see in a mirror blurry now, but *we'll see* directly then. I know partly now, but then I'll know as I'm known. [13]There's faith, hope, and love now—those three; but love is the most important. **1 Cor 12:31- 13:13**

How Speaking in Languages Works

14:[1]Focus on practicing love, and earnestly desire spiritual *gifts* so you can communicate. [2]A person that's speaking in *another* language isn't speaking to anybody but God because nobody is understanding *what* the Spirit is enabling him to say. [3]A person that communicates, helps, encourages, comforts *other* people. [4]Somebody that speaks in *another* language helps himself, but a person that communicates helps the church. [5]Now I'm willing for all of you to speak in languages, but so you can communicate. If you communicate, you're doing something more important than talking in *other* languages—unless you translate so you can help the church. **1 Cor 14:1-5**

[6]If I come to you speaking in *other* languages, how will I be helping you unless I'm giving revelation, knowledge, prophecy, or teaching? [7]Even inanimate things that make sounds—like flutes or harps—if they don't make definite tones, how will listeners recognize what the flute or harp is playing? [8]If a bugle makes random sounds, who's going to arm for battle? [9]In the same way, unless you speak clearly in a language, how are people going to understand you? You'll be talking into the air. [10]There are lots of *languages* in the world, and they all convey meaning. [11]If I don't understand what the sound means, we're foreigners to each other. [12]So since you're enthused about spiritual *gifts*, aim at helping the church *with them*. [13]Whoever speaks in *another* language should pray to be able to translate it. [14]If I'm praying in *another* language, my spirit's praying, but my mind isn't understanding the words I'm saying. **1 Cor 14:6-14**

[15]What, then? I'll pray with the spirit and the mind. I'll sing with the spirit and the mind. [16]Otherwise, if I'm blessing with the spirit, how can the ungifted say, *"Amen,"* when I give thanks? He won't be understanding me. [17]I'll be giving thanks all right, but I won't be helping him. [18]I thank God that I speak in *other* languages more than all of you do, [19]but in church I'd

rather say five words with my mind so I can teach other people than 10,000 words in *another* language. **1 Cor 14:15-19**

20Don't think like little kids. (Be *innocent* like little kids when it comes to evil.) In your minds, be grown-ups. **21**The Law says,

> ***"'I'll speak to this people***
> ***in foreign languages***
> ***with the lips of foreigners;***
> ***they won't listen to** me **even** that way,' the LORD says"* **[Is 28:11; Deut 28:49].**

22So *other* languages serve as signs for unbelievers, *more than* believers; prophecy is for believers, *more than* unbelievers. **23**If the church gets together, and everybody is speaking in *other* languages, and ungifted or unbelievers come in, won't they say you're out of your mind? **24**But if everybody's speaking on behalf of *God* and unbelievers or laymen come in, you'll be convicting them and calling them to account. **25**Their inner yearnings will become clear, and they'll fall on their faces and worship God. They'll declare, *"God has to be among you."*

1 Cor 14:20-25

Orderly Assembly

26What, then? When you get together, and each one has a psalm, a teaching, a revelation, a language, a translation, do everything to benefit *one another*. **27**If people speak in *another* language, two or at most three should take turns, and one should translate. **28**If there's no translator, they need to be quiet and talk to themselves and to God. **29**Two or three prophets can speak, and the others think about *what they're saying*. **30**If a revelation comes to somebody else that's sitting *there*, the first should yield the floor. **31**You can all take turns prophesying so everybody can learn and be encouraged. **32**The spirits of prophets are subject to the prophets; **33**God brings peace, not confusion. **1 Cor 14:26-33a**

Women's Decorum in Church

As in all the churches of the saints, **34**women should remain silent in church services and practice deference like the Law says. **35**If they want to find out about something, they can ask their husbands at home; it's embarrassing for a woman to speak out in church. **36**Did the word of God come from you, or did it come just to you?

37If you consider *yourself* a prophet or spiritual person, you need to recognize that what I'm writing to you is the Lord's command. **38**If anyone ignores *that*, ignore them. **39**So, *go ahead and* earnestly desire to prophesy and let people speak in *other* languages, **40**but do everything properly and orderly. **1 Cor 14:33b-40**

The Resurrection of Jesus

15:1 My fellow Christians, I want you to know the most important thing in the good news I delivered to you, that you accepted, that you stand in, **2**that saves you if you hold onto it (unless you've believed for nothing): **3**Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures, **4**was buried, was resurrected the third day according to the scriptures, **5**appeared to Cephas, then the Twelve, **6**then to more than 500 disciples at the same time (most of them are still alive). **7**Next he appeared to James and then to all the apostles. **8**Last, he appeared to me like someone born out of season. **9**I'm the least of the apostles and don't deserve to be called one because I persecuted God's church. **10**But by God's grace I am what I am, and his grace to me has produced results. I've worked harder than any of them—not *so much* me, but God's grace in me. **11**So whether it's me or them, *Christ's resurrection* is what we proclaimed and what you believed. **1 Cor 15:1-11**

The Resurrection of People

12If we proclaimed that Christ resurrected, how can some of you say there's no such thing as resurrection? **13**If that's true, Christ hasn't resurrected. **14**If he didn't, then our preaching is worthless and so's your faith. **15**Besides, we're false witnesses for God because we've claimed he resurrected Christ, which he didn't do if there's no such thing as resurrection. **16**If dead people don't resurrect, Christ didn't. **17**If he didn't resurrect, your faith is useless, you're still in your sins, **18**and the dead in Christ have perished. **19**If we have hope in Christ only in this life, we're the most pitiable people alive. **1 Cor 15:12-19**

20But, Christ has resurrected, the firstfruits from the dead. **21**Since death *came* by man, resurrection came by man. **22**As in Adam people die, so in Christ people resurrect—**23**each in sequence: Christ the firstfruits, then the ones that belong to him when he comes back. **24**Then the end will come, when he does away with all *other* rule, authority, and power. **25**He needs to reign till he overcomes all his enemies. **26**The last enemy he'll overcome is death. **27*"God will subject everything to him"*** **[Ps 8:6].** When it says *"everything,"* obviously it doesn't include the One who did the *"subjecting."* **28**When God subjects *"everything"* to the Son, the Son will be subject to God, so God will be ultimate in everything. **1 Cor 15:20-28**

Ministry and the Hope of Resurrection

29Otherwise, what will the ones baptized on behalf of the dead be doing? If the dead don't resurrect, why be baptized on their behalf? **30**Why do we face danger all the time? **31**By the pride we take in you, *the pride* we have in Christ Jesus our Lord, *I tell you,* I die every day. **32**If, figuratively speaking, I fought wild animals in Ephesus, what good *did it do*? If the dead don't resurrect,

"Let's eat and drink;
we're going to die tomorrow" **[Is 22:13; 56:12].**

[33]Don't kid yourselves,

"Bad company ruins good morals."

[34]Come to your senses about goodness, and don't practice sinning. It's a shame to say it, but some *of you* don't know God. **1 Cor 15:29-34**

The Resurrected Body

[35]Somebody might ask, *"How do dead people resurrect? What kind of body do they come with?"* [36]Foolish *one*! What you plant doesn't come to life unless it dies. [37]What you plant isn't the body it's going to become. You plant bare wheat seed, for example. [38]God gives it the body he wants it to have, and each *kind of* seed has its own shape. [39] People, cattle, birds, and fish all look different. [40]Things in the sky differ from things on the ground in how impressive they are. Things in the sky differ from each other in brightness—[41]the sun's brighter than the moon; the moon's brighter than the stars; the stars differ in how bright they are. **1 Cor 15:35-41**

[42]That's how resurrection is. What's planted in decay resurrects unable to decay; [43]what's planted in dishonor resurrects in honor; what's planted in weakness resurrects in power; [44]what's planted as a physical body resurrects as a spiritual one. There's a physical body and a spiritual body. [45]Scripture says,

"The** first **man** Adam **became a living being" **[Gen 2:7]**;

the last Adam *became* a life-giving spirit. [46]But, the spiritual doesn't come first; the physical comes, then the spiritual. [47]The first man is from the dust of the earth; the second man *is* from heaven. [48]Earthly people are like the earth; heavenly ones are like heaven. [49]As we've been like the earth, we'll be like heaven. **1 Cor 15:42-49**

Victory Through Resurrection

[50]I'm saying that because flesh and blood can't inherit God's kingdom. What perishes doesn't inherit what doesn't perish. [51]I'll tell you a mystery: not everybody will die, but everybody will be changed—[52]in an instant, in the blink of an eye, at the last trumpet blast. The trumpet will blow, and the dead will resurrect imperishable, and we'll be changed. [53]This perishable *body* must put on what's not perishable; this mortal *body* must put on immortality. [54]When that happens, what's written will take place,

"Victory has swallowed up death **[Is 25:8].**

[55]***Death, where's your victory?***

Death, where's your sting?" **[Hos 13:14]**

[56]"Death's sting" is sin, and sin's power is law. [57]Thank God, who gives us the "victory" through our Lord Jesus Christ. [58]So stay steadfast, unmovable, always excelling in the Lord's work. You know your labor in the Lord amounts to something. **1 Cor 15:50-58**

The Collection for Hebrew Christians

16:1 About the collection for the saints. Do what I told the churches in Galatia. **2**Every first *day* of the week, each of you lay aside in store as things go for you, so there won't be any collecting after I get there. **3**When I arrive, whoever you appoint, I'll send with letters to carry your gift to Jerusalem. **4**If it's appropriate for me to go too, we'll go together.

5I'll see you after I go through Macedonia. **6**I can stay with you a while or even spend the winter so you can send me on. **7**I don't want to see you this time in passing, because I hope to stay a while, Lord willing. **8**I'm going to stay in Ephesus till Pentecost **9**because a wide, effective door has opened up for me, although there's a lot of opposition. **1 Cor 16:1-9**

The Activities of Paul's Fellow Workers

10If Timothy comes, see that he's welcome. He's doing the Lord's work like I am. **11**Nobody should disregard him but send him on in peace so he can come back to me. I expect him *to come* with the disciples.

12I strongly urged Apollos to come to you with the *others*, but he really didn't want to come now. He'll come when he can.

13Stay alert, stand firm in the faith; be courageous and strong. **14**Everything you do, do with love.

15-16 You know that the family of Stephanas was the firstfruits of Achaia, and *that* they've devoted themselves to serving the saints. I urge you to cooperate with people like them and with everybody that labors in the work. **17**I was so glad Stephanas, Fortunatus, and Achaicus came, because they supplied what you hadn't yet provided. **18**They've refreshed me—and you. Give recognition to people like them. **1 Cor 16:10-18**

Greetings and Benediction

19The churches in Asia send you greetings. Aquila and Prisca greet you warmly along with the church *that meets* in their house. **20**The disciples all send their regards; greet one another with a holy kiss.

21The salutation with my own hand—Paul.

22If somebody doesn't love the Lord, let him be accursed. Lord, come!

23The grace of the Lord Jesus *be* with you. **24**My love *is* with you all in Christ Jesus. Amen. **1 Cor 16:19-24**